MODULE 2

What a Story

"They weren't true stories; they were better than that."

— ALICE HOFFMAN

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How does genre affect the way a story is told?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**Airborn**	· Kenneth Oppel (illus. Antonio Javier Caparo)	FANTASY / ADVENTURE
2	**The Secret Garden**	· Frances Hodgson Burnett (illus. Helena Perez Garcia)	REALISTIC FICTION
3	**The Miracle of Spring**	· Helen Hanna (illus. Olga Baumert)	PLAY
4	**The Poem That Will Not End**	· Joan Bransfield Graham (illus. Kyrsten Brooker)	POETRY

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B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 6

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 12

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 15

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 2 · What a Story · Grade 5 · 30 Items

CCSS L.5.4 · L.5.5 · L.5.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.5.6

prose

Unlike poetry, **prose** is —

- ◯ **A.** words set to music to be sung.
- ◯ **B.** a list of rhyming lines.
- ◯ **C.** ordinary writing in the form of sentences and paragraphs.
- ◯ **D.** a drawing that tells a story.

Q2 L.5.6

dialogue

The **dialogue** in a story is —

- ◯ **A.** the place where the story happens.
- ◯ **B.** a picture at the top of the page.
- ◯ **C.** the title printed on the cover.
- ◯ **D.** the conversation among the characters.

Q3 L.5.6

climax

The **climax** of a story is —

- ◯ **A.** its most important event, which usually happens near the end.
- ◯ **B.** the very first sentence on page one.
- ◯ **C.** a list of the characters' names.
- ◯ **D.** the author's note about the book.

Q4 L.5.6

foreword

The **foreword** of a book is —

- **A.** the longest chapter in the middle.
- **B.** a map of where the story takes place.
- **C.** the introduction to the book.
- **D.** the list of words at the very back.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · AIRBORN

Q5 L.5.5 TRAP

panic

When **panic** swept over Matt, he felt —

- **A.** a calm, sleepy contentment.
- **B.** a feeling of strong fear that left him unable to think clearly.
- **C.** a sudden burst of laughter.
- **D.** a mild curiosity about the weather.

Q6 L.5.4

favorable

Molloy tried to catch **favorable** winds. Something **favorable** —

- **A.** gives a benefit or contributes to success.
- **B.** spins in circles with no direction.
- **C.** blocks you from reaching a goal.
- **D.** makes a loud, frightening noise.

Q7 L.5.4

porthole

Matt looked at the stars outside his **porthole**. A **porthole** is —

- **A.** a rope used to tie down a sail.
- **B.** a ladder that leads to the deck.
- **C.** a small round window on a ship.
- **D.** a map of the ocean currents.

Q8 L.5.4

densely

The island was **densely** forested. If something is covered **densely**, the covering is —

- **A.** painted a bright color.
- **B.** spread out thinly with gaps.
- **C.** so thick that it is difficult to see through.
- **D.** floating high above the ground.

Q9 L.5.5 TRAP

reasonable

At first the log was clear and **reasonable**. Something **reasonable** is —

- **A.** confusing and impossible to follow.
- **B.** logical and easy to understand.
- **C.** written in a foreign language.
- **D.** torn into many small pieces.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · AIRBORN (CONTINUED)

Q10 L.5.4

delirious

Matt wondered if Molloy was **delirious**. When someone is **delirious**, he or she is —

- **A.** confused due to fever or illness.
- **B.** wide awake and very alert.
- **C.** quietly reading a book.
- **D.** proud of a job well done.

Q11 L.5.5 TRAP

projected

Matt thought Molloy's brain had **projected** the creatures. Something that is **projected** —

- **A.** is solid and can be touched by anyone.
- **B.** has been proven to be completely real.
- **C.** is locked safely inside a box.
- **D.** may appear to be real but is not.

Q12 L.5.4

contents

The captain would never share the **contents** of another captain's log. The **contents** of a document are —

- ◯ **A.** the topics or subjects it includes.
- ◯ **B.** the people who guard it.
- ◯ **C.** the cover and the binding.
- ◯ **D.** the price it was sold for.

Q13 L.5.4

deficiencies

The letter mentioned "**deficiencies** of observation." If something has **deficiencies**, it has —

- ◯ **A.** extra strengths and powers.
- ◯ **B.** a bright and shining surface.
- ◯ **C.** many helpful instructions.
- ◯ **D.** weaknesses or flaws.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE SECRET GARDEN

Q14 L.5.5 TRAP

mysterious

The tangled garden looked **mysterious**. Something that is **mysterious** is —

- ◯ **A.** brightly lit and easy to see.
- ◯ **B.** neat, tidy, and well known.
- ◯ **C.** loud and full of noise.
- ◯ **D.** not fully understood or explainable.

Q15 L.5.5 TRAP

matted

The climbing roses were so thick they were **matted** together. Something that is **matted** is —

- ◯ **A.** trimmed into a neat shape.
- ◯ **B.** planted in a straight row.
- ◯ **C.** a tangled mess.
- ◯ **D.** freshly painted and shining.

Q16 L.5.4

tendrils

The roses swung down long **tendrils**. **Tendrils** of plants are —

- **A.** the wide, flat leaves at the base.
- **B.** long, thin sections that often twist around an object or another plant.
- **C.** the seeds buried in the soil.
- **D.** the thick trunks near the ground.

Q17 L.5.4

fastenings

The branches had fallen from their **fastenings**. **Fastenings** are things that —

- **A.** water the plants each morning.
- **B.** cut the grass very short.
- **C.** give off a sweet smell.
- **D.** attach objects to other things.

Q18 L.5.4

awakening

Mary stepped softly, as if afraid of **awakening** someone. If you are **awakening** someone, you are —

- **A.** waking him or her from sleep.
- **B.** singing a song to them.
- **C.** hiding a gift for them.
- **D.** drawing a picture of them.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE MIRACLE OF SPRING

Q19 L.5.4

witness

Mrs. Apple Tree took the stand as a **witness**. A **witness** is someone who —

- **A.** writes the rules for a game.
- **B.** sells tickets at the door.
- **C.** appears in court to say what he or she knows about a crime.
- **D.** sweeps the floor after the show.

Q20 L.5.4

presiding

Judge Wise Owl was **presiding** over the court. If you are **presiding** over an event, you are —

- ◯ **A.** in charge of it.
- ◯ **B.** watching it quietly from the back.
- ◯ **C.** arriving late to the event.
- ◯ **D.** performing on the stage.

Q21 L.5.5 TRAP

attempted

The King was charged with **attempted** murder. If you **attempted** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** refused to do it.
- ◯ **B.** tried to do it.
- ◯ **C.** finished it perfectly.
- ◯ **D.** forgot all about it.

Q22 L.5.4

restrain

The judge warned the King to **restrain** himself. When you **restrain** yourself, you —

- ◯ **A.** stop yourself from doing what you want to do.
- ◯ **B.** shout as loudly as you can.
- ◯ **C.** run quickly out of the room.
- ◯ **D.** fall fast asleep.

Q23 L.5.5 TRAP

contempt

The King could be held in **contempt** of court. When you show **contempt**, you show —

- ◯ **A.** deep admiration and respect.
- ◯ **B.** careful, patient attention.
- ◯ **C.** great sympathy and kindness.
- ◯ **D.** little or no respect for someone or something.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE POEM THAT WILL NOT END

Q24 L.5.4

seized

The poet was **seized** by a rhythmical beat. If you were **seized** by an idea or feeling, you were —

- ◯ **A.** slowly bored by it.
- ◯ **B.** suddenly overwhelmed by it.
- ◯ **C.** completely free of it.
- ◯ **D.** gently reminded of it.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE POEM THAT WILL NOT END (CONTINUED)

Q25 L.5.4

hesitate

The poet didn't **hesitate** to scribble on the napkins. If you **hesitate**, you —

- ◯ **A.** act at once without any pause.
- ◯ **B.** shout your answer right away.
- ◯ **C.** wait to speak or act because you're not sure what to say or do.
- ◯ **D.** finish a job ahead of time.

Q26 L.5.5 TRAP

watchful

A good poet stays **watchful** for ideas. If you are **watchful**, you —

- ◯ **A.** close your eyes and ignore everything.
- ◯ **B.** pay attention to everything around you.
- ◯ **C.** sleep through the whole day.
- ◯ **D.** forget what you just saw.

Q27 L.5.4

scrawled

The poet **scrawled** a verse across his plate. If you **scrawled** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** wrote it quickly and sloppily.
- ◯ **B.** typed it on a computer.
- ◯ **C.** printed it in neat, careful letters.
- ◯ **D.** read it aloud to a crowd.

Q28 L.5.4

ditty

The poet wrote a cheerful little **ditty**. A **ditty** is —

- **A.** a long, serious novel.
- **B.** a song or poem that is short and cheerful.
- **C.** a set of stage directions.
- **D.** a heavy book of rules.

Q29 L.5.4

refrain

Each poem ended with the same **refrain**. A **refrain** is —

- **A.** the title written above the poem.
- **B.** a drawing next to the words.
- **C.** a verse or phrase that is repeated in a song or poem.
- **D.** the name of the poet.

Q30 L.5.5 TRAP

restless

The poet spent a **restless** night thinking of rhymes. If you are **restless**, you —

- **A.** sleep deeply and peacefully.
- **B.** feel rested and full of energy.
- **C.** sit perfectly calm and quiet.
- **D.** find it hard to relax or stay still.

B Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 2 · What a Story · Grade 5 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.5.1 · RL.5.2 · RL.5.3 · RL.5.5 · RL.5.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Airborn

FANTASY / ADVENTURE · KENNETH OPPEL · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.5.2

What is this part of "Airborn" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** A girl unlocks a hidden garden behind a wall.
- ◯ **B.** Animals put a king on trial in a court.
- ◯ **C.** Matt reads Benjamin Molloy's journal and tries to figure out whether the strange flying creatures Molloy described are real.
- ◯ **D.** A poet cannot stop writing poems.

Q2 RL.5.6

From whose point of view is this part of the story told?

- ◯ **A.** Benjamin Molloy, the balloonist, telling his own tale.
- ◯ **B.** Kate, speaking only to the reader.
- ◯ **C.** Matt Cruse, a cabin boy who tells the story using the word "I."
- ◯ **D.** An outside narrator who never enters the story.

Q3 RL.5.3

How do the early entries in Molloy's journal differ from the last ones?

- ◯ **A.** The early entries have no dates, while the last ones are very detailed.
- ◯ **B.** The early entries are written by Kate, the last ones by Matt.
- ◯ **C.** The early and last entries are exactly the same.
- ◯ **D.** The early entries are clear and dated, but the last ones become strange, smeared, and undated.

Q4 RL.5.3

Why does Matt doubt that the creatures are real?

- ◯ **A.** He has seen the creatures himself and was disappointed.
- ◯ **B.** Kate told him the journal was a joke.
- ◯ **C.** The captain warned him the creatures were dangerous.
- ◯ **D.** He thinks Molloy was ill and that his fevered brain may have imagined the creatures by the end of the log.

Q5 RL.5.1

What can you tell about Matt from the way he reads the journal late into the night?

- ◯ **A.** He is bored and reads only because he must.
- ◯ **B.** He is curious and drawn to adventure, eager to know what Molloy found.
- ◯ **C.** He is afraid of the dark and cannot sleep.
- ◯ **D.** He dislikes Molloy and wants to mock him.

Q6 RL.5.6

How does Kate's view of the creatures differ from Matt's?

- ◯ **A.** Kate firmly believes her grandfather truly saw the creatures, while Matt doubts they are real.
- ◯ **B.** Kate thinks the creatures were imagined, while Matt is certain they are real.
- ◯ **C.** Both Kate and Matt are sure the creatures never existed.
- ◯ **D.** Neither Kate nor Matt has any opinion about the creatures.

Q7 RL.5.3

How does Kate try to persuade Matt that the creatures could be real?

- ◯ **A.** She offers to pay him for his help.
- ◯ **B.** She argues that the whole sky has not yet been explored and that airships have flown for only about fifty years.
- ◯ **C.** She shows him a photograph of a creature.
- ◯ **D.** She asks the captain to order Matt to agree.

Q8 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of this part of "Airborn"?

- ◯ **A.** Curiosity and an open mind can lead people to wonder about marvels that have not yet been explained.
- ◯ **B.** Journals should always be written in ink.
- ◯ **C.** Airships are the safest way to travel.
- ◯ **D.** Cabin boys should never read other people's logs.

Selection 2 · The Secret Garden

REALISTIC FICTION · FRANCES HODGSON BURNETT · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.5.2

What is this part of "The Secret Garden" mostly about?

- **A.** A cabin boy reads a strange journal at night.
- **B.** Animals hold a trial for a king.
- **C.** Mary finds the hidden door, unlocks the long-closed secret garden, and steps inside.
- **D.** A poet writes verses with bananas.

Q10 RL.5.3

What problem does Mary face after she finds the key?

- **A.** She loses the key in the grass.
- **B.** The robin flies away with the key.
- **C.** The key is too large for any lock.
- **D.** She does not know where the door to the secret garden is, so she cannot use the key.

Q11 RL.5.3

What finally helps Mary discover the hidden door?

- **A.** Ben Weatherstaff points it out to her.
- **B.** A gust of wind swings aside the ivy, and she sees the round knob of a door beneath the leaves.
- **C.** She digs through the dirt with her hands.
- **D.** She climbs over the high wall.

Q12 RL.5.6

From what point of view is "The Secret Garden" told?

- **A.** Mary tells her own story using the word "I."
- **B.** An outside narrator describes Mary using words like "she."
- **C.** The robin narrates the events.
- **D.** The garden itself speaks to the reader.

Q13 RL.5.1

Which detail BEST shows how Mary feels as she opens the door?

- **A.** She yawns and decides to come back another day.
- **B.** She calls loudly for Ben Weatherstaff to help.
- **C.** She drops the key and walks away.
- **D.** Her heart begins to thump and her hands shake "in her delight and excitement."

Q14 RL.5.3

What does the garden look like when Mary first steps inside?

- ◯ **A.** Still and mysterious, with leafless roses matted together and brown, wintry grass.
- ◯ **B.** Bright with blooming flowers and neat green hedges.
- ◯ **C.** Filled with people working and talking.
- ◯ **D.** Covered with deep snow and ice.

Q15 RL.5.5

How is this part of the story structured?

- ◯ **A.** As a poem with rhyming stanzas.
- ◯ **B.** As a list of facts under headings.
- ◯ **C.** It builds toward one key moment — Mary finding and opening the door — and then her wonder at what is inside.
- ◯ **D.** As a set of letters between two characters.

Q16 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of this part of "The Secret Garden"?

- ◯ **A.** Patience and curiosity can lead a person to discover a hidden, forgotten place full of wonder.
- ◯ **B.** Robins are smarter than people.
- ◯ **C.** Gardens should always be kept locked.
- ◯ **D.** Keys are easy to lose in the dirt.

Selection 3 · The Miracle of Spring

PLAY · HELEN HANNA · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.5.2

What is "The Miracle of Spring" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** A cabin boy reads a balloonist's journal.
- ◯ **B.** The animals of Mother Nature's Court put King Bartholomew on trial for keeping Spring locked away.
- ◯ **C.** A girl unlocks a hidden garden.
- ◯ **D.** A poet cannot stop writing verses.

Q18 RL.5.5

How is this selection organized, and how can you tell it is a play?

- **A.** It is one long paragraph with no breaks.
- **B.** It is a poem with repeated refrains.
- **C.** It is a list of facts with photographs.
- **D.** It is told mostly through characters' dialogue and stage directions, and it is divided into scenes.

Q19 RL.5.1

What is King Bartholomew accused of in the trial?

- **A.** Stealing honey from the bees.
- **B.** Attempted murder — trying to starve everyone by forbidding spring.
- **C.** Refusing to pay the court.
- **D.** Cutting down Mrs. Apple Tree.

Q20 RL.5.3

Why does Eager Beaver call the witnesses to speak?

- **A.** To entertain the king with a show.
- **B.** To teach the jury how to plant crops.
- **C.** To choose a new judge for the court.
- **D.** To prove that without spring there will be no fruit, no flowers, and no food.

Q21 RL.5.5

Which moment is the climax, or turning point, of the play?

- **A.** Crow steps in through the window at the very start.
- **B.** The judge asks for the first case.
- **C.** The jury chants "Guilty!" and a bell tolls, after which the court characters quickly disappear.
- **D.** The door guard greets the king in the morning.

Q22 RL.5.3

What does the dialogue in Scene 2 reveal about the trial in Scene 1?

- **A.** The whole trial was the king's dream.
- **B.** The trial was held in a different kingdom.
- **C.** The trial will continue the next day.
- **D.** The king won the case against Mother Nature.

Q23 RL.5.3

How does King Bartholomew change by the end of the play?

- **A.** He wakes feeling sorry and orders that Spring be freed so he can apologize.
- **B.** He grows angrier and locks Spring away forever.
- **C.** He refuses to speak to anyone in the castle.
- **D.** He decides to put the animals on trial instead.

Q24 RL.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a theme of "The Miracle of Spring"?

- **A.** Owls make the best judges.
- **B.** Dreams never mean anything.
- **C.** Going against the natural order harms everyone, and it is never too late to admit a mistake and set things right.
- **D.** Kings should always get their way.

Selection 4 · The Poem That Will Not End

POETRY · JOAN BRANSFIELD GRAHAM · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.5.2

What is "The Poem That Will Not End" mostly about?

- **A.** A cabin boy reading a journal at night.
- **B.** A young poet who is so full of rhythm and rhyme that he cannot stop writing poems.
- **C.** A girl opening a locked garden.
- **D.** A king on trial in an animal court.

Q26 RL.5.5

How is this selection organized?

- **A.** As a single long paragraph of prose.
- **B.** As scenes with stage directions.
- **C.** As a series of poems, many followed by a label that names the poem's form.
- **D.** As a list of dated journal entries.

Q27 RL.5.5

In the poem "Rhythm," which lines rhyme?

- **A.** No lines rhyme at all.
- **B.** Only the first and last lines rhyme.
- **C.** The rhyme pattern is AABBA, as in *beat, delete, rhyme, time, feet*.
- **D.** Every line rhymes with every other line.

Q28 RL.5.6

From whose point of view are the poems written?

- **A.** A first-person speaker, the poet, who uses the word "I."
- **B.** An outside narrator who never appears.
- **C.** The poet's baby brother.
- **D.** A teacher describing the class.

Q29 RL.5.3

What does the poet do because he cannot stop thinking in poetry?

- **A.** He stops writing altogether.
- **B.** He asks his brother to write for him.
- **C.** He hides all of his pencils.
- **D.** He scribbles verses on napkins and doodles across his plate at breakfast.

Q30 RL.5.5

Why does the author put a form label after many of the poems?

- **A.** To show who illustrated each poem.
- **B.** To list the page numbers.
- **C.** To give the price of the book.
- **D.** To help readers see and learn the different forms a poem can take, such as a limerick.

Q31 RL.5.6

What is the author's main purpose in this selection?

- **A.** To explain exactly how to build a machine.
- **B.** To delight readers with playful poems while showing how many forms and voices poetry can use.
- **C.** To warn readers never to write poems.
- **D.** To report true news from a newspaper.

Q32 RL.5.2 TRAP

What is the main THEME, or message, of "The Poem That Will Not End"?

- **A.** Poetic inspiration can be playful and unstoppable, bubbling up everywhere in many different forms.
- **B.** The poet wrote a poem labeled "Limerick."
- **C.** The poet doodled with bananas on a high-chair tray.
- **D.** One of the poems is called "Rhythm."

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 2 · What a Story · Grade 5

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how genre shapes a story. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Perspective DOK 3

In **"Airborn,"** Matt and Kate disagree about the flying creatures. Show what EACH one believes, then explain how the first-person point of view shapes the story.

TWO POINTS OF VIEW · AIRBORN

WHAT MATT BELIEVES	WHAT KATE BELIEVES	THE EVIDENCE THEY USE

The story is told by Matt using the word "I." How would the story feel different if Kate told it instead? Use the words *point of view* in your answer.

Q2 Imagination DOK 3

In **"The Secret Garden,"** Mary discovers a hidden place. Show the STEPS she takes to get inside, then explain the lesson.

A HIDDEN DISCOVERY · THE SECRET GARDEN

THE PROBLEM	WHAT SHE DID	WHAT SHE FOUND
what could Mary not find?	*how did she find the door?*	*what was inside?*

Mary waited, watched, and kept trying. Why is it important that she did not give up? Explain using the word *curiosity*.

Q3 Form DOK 3

In **"The Miracle of Spring,"** the story is told as a PLAY. Compare how a play tells a story with how a regular story (prose) tells one, then explain the lesson.

HOW A PLAY TELLS A STORY · THE MIRACLE OF SPRING

A PLAY (DRAMA)	A REGULAR STORY (PROSE)

A play uses dialogue, stage directions, and scenes. Why does telling this trial as a play make it fun to watch and perform? Explain.

Q4 Creativity DOK 3

In **"The Poem That Will Not End,"** the poet plays with the sounds and forms of words. Show one SOUND tool and one FORM the poet uses, then explain what poetry can do that prose cannot.

THE MUSIC OF POETRY · THE POEM THAT WILL NOT END

A SOUND TOOL (RHYME, RHYTHM, REFRAIN)	A POETIC FORM (SUCH AS A LIMERICK)

The poet cannot stop writing in rhyme and rhythm. Why does the author use poetry, not prose, to share these ideas? Use the word *imagination* in your answer.

Q5 Inquiry DOK 4

Essential Question: How does genre affect the way a story is told? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What genre is it, and how does that genre shape the way the story is told?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What genre is it, and how does that genre shape the way the story is told?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 2 · What a Story · Grade 5

MAP RIT 205 → 225 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Lighthouse Keeper's Cat

Old Tomas lived alone in a lighthouse on a rocky island, with no one for company but a gray cat named Pip. Every evening Tomas climbed the winding stairs to light the great lamp, and Pip followed at his heels. One stormy night the wind howled so hard that the windows rattled, and a thick fog rolled in from the sea. Tomas lit the lamp as always, but the fog was so heavy that the light could barely shine through. Far out on the water, a small fishing boat was lost. The sailors could not see the rocks, and the rocks could not be seen. Then Pip did a curious thing. The cat leaped onto the great brass bell by the door and swatted it with both paws, again and again. The deep clang rang out across the water. The lost sailors heard the bell, turned their boat toward the sound, and steered safely past the rocks into the harbor. In the morning the grateful sailors came to thank Tomas. He only smiled and pointed at Pip, curled up and purring in a patch of sun. "It was the cat," he said, "who saved you all."

196 WORDS · LEXILE 640–720L · RIT 205–211

Q1 RIT 205 · Lexile 640L · Key Detail

Where does Tomas live?

- ◯ **A.** On a fishing boat at sea.
- ◯ **B.** In a town near the harbor.
- ◯ **C.** In a lighthouse on a rocky island.
- ◯ **D.** In a cabin in the forest.

Q2 RIT 207 · Lexile 660L · Cause & Effect

Why could the lamp barely help the lost boat that night?

- ◯ **A.** A thick fog was so heavy that the light could barely shine through.
- ◯ **B.** The lamp had run out of oil.
- ◯ **C.** Tomas forgot to climb the stairs.
- ◯ **D.** The sailors were not looking.

Q3 RIT 208 · Lexile 680L · Key Detail

What did Pip the cat do to help the sailors?

- ◯ **A.** The cat swam out to the boat.
- ◯ **B.** The cat lit the great lamp.
- ◯ **C.** The cat called out to the sailors.
- ◯ **D.** The cat leaped onto the brass bell and swatted it again and again.

Q4 RIT 210 · Lexile 700L · Vocabulary

The story says the bell's "deep **clang** rang out across the water." The word **clang** means a —

- ◯ **A.** soft whisper.
- ◯ **B.** bright flash of light.
- ◯ **C.** loud ringing sound.
- ◯ **D.** gentle breeze.

Q5 RIT 211 · Lexile 720L · Theme

What is the lesson, or theme, of this story?

- ◯ **A.** Lighthouses should be painted gray.
- ◯ **B.** Even a small, unexpected helper can do something brave and important.
- ◯ **C.** Cats do not like storms.
- ◯ **D.** Sailors should never go out at night.

Passage 2 · The Same Tale, Told Three Ways

Have you ever noticed that the same story can be told in many different ways? Imagine a tale about a fox who tricks a crow into dropping its cheese. A storyteller might tell it as a fable, a short story with talking animals that ends with a clear lesson, such as "Do not trust flattery." A poet might tell the very same tale as a poem, using rhyme and rhythm to make the fox's smooth words sing on the page. A playwright might turn it into a short play, where two actors wear fox and crow costumes and speak the lines aloud on a stage, with notes that tell them where to stand. Each way of telling the tale is called a genre, and each genre has its own tools. A fable uses plain sentences and a moral. A poem uses sound and shape. A play uses dialogue and stage directions. The events of the story stay the same — the fox still tricks the crow — but the genre changes how we hear and feel it. That is the magic of storytelling: one idea can wear many different costumes, and each costume shows the story in a fresh new light.

199 WORDS · LEXILE 720–820L · RIT 211–217

Q6 RIT 211 · Lexile 720L · Key Detail

What tale does the passage use as its example?

- ◯ **A.** A fox who tricks a crow into dropping its cheese.
- ◯ **B.** A king who locks away spring.
- ◯ **C.** A girl who finds a hidden garden.
- ◯ **D.** A cat who rings a bell.

Q7 RIT 213 · Lexile 750L · Text Structure

How does the author organize this passage?

- ◯ **A.** By telling the events of one day in order.
- ◯ **B.** By listing the steps to write a fable.
- ◯ **C.** By describing one character from head to toe.
- ◯ **D.** By comparing three genres — fable, poem, and play — that tell the same tale.

Q8 RIT 214 · Lexile 780L · Key Detail

According to the passage, which tools does a play use to tell a story?

- ◯ **A.** Rhyme and rhythm.
- ◯ **B.** Plain sentences and a moral.
- ◯ **C.** Dialogue and stage directions.
- ◯ **D.** Photographs and captions.

Q9 RIT 215 · Lexile 800L · Vocabulary

In this passage, the word **genre** means a —

- ◯ **A.** costume worn by an actor.
- ◯ **B.** type or kind of storytelling, each with its own tools.
- ◯ **C.** piece of cheese.
- ◯ **D.** lesson at the end of a fable.

Q10 RIT 217 · Lexile 820L · Main Idea

What is the main idea of "The Same Tale, Told Three Ways"?

- ◯ **A.** Foxes are smarter than crows.
- ◯ **B.** The same story can be told in different genres, and each genre changes how we hear and feel it.
- ◯ **C.** Plays are better than poems.
- ◯ **D.** Every story needs a costume.

Passage 3 · The Boy Who Spoke in Rhyme

There once was a boy named Lev who could not help speaking in rhyme. When his mother asked him to clean his room, he answered, "I'll sweep the floor and shut the door!" When his teacher called on him in class, his reply came out in a neat little verse. At first the other children laughed, and Lev felt his cheeks grow hot. He tried hard to speak in plain words, the way everyone else did, but the rhymes kept bubbling up like water from a spring. One gray afternoon, the class was asked to write a poem. While the others chewed their pencils and stared at blank pages, Lev's pen flew across the paper. His poem was full of bouncing rhythm and clever rhyme, and when he read it aloud, the whole class clapped. His teacher smiled and said, "Lev, your gift is not something to hide. It is something to share." From that day on, Lev no longer felt ashamed. He still spoke in rhyme, but now the other children leaned in to listen, eager to hear what he would say next. What had seemed like a problem turned out to be his greatest talent.

197 WORDS · LEXILE 760–860L · RIT 217–222

Q11 RIT 217 Lexile 760L Key Detail

What is unusual about the way Lev speaks?

- **A.** He speaks only in a whisper.
- **B.** He never speaks at all.
- **C.** He cannot help speaking in rhyme.
- **D.** He speaks in another language.

Q12 RIT 218 Lexile 790L Cause & Effect

Why does Lev feel his cheeks grow hot at the beginning?

- **A.** He has run a long race.
- **B.** The room is too warm.
- **C.** He won a prize for his poem.
- **D.** The other children laugh at the way he speaks in rhyme.

Q13 RIT 219 Lexile 820L Inference

When the author writes that "the rhymes kept bubbling up like water from a spring," it shows that —

- **A.** Lev was thirsty for water.
- **B.** the rhymes came naturally and could not be stopped.
- **C.** there was a spring near the school.
- **D.** Lev had stopped speaking in rhyme.

Q14 RIT 220 Lexile 840L Cause & Effect

What happens after Lev reads his poem aloud to the class?

- **A.** The teacher asks him to stop.
- **B.** The other children leave the room.
- **C.** He decides never to write again.
- **D.** The whole class claps, and he no longer feels ashamed.

Q15 RIT 222 · Lexile 860L · Theme

What is the theme of "The Boy Who Spoke in Rhyme"?

- ◯ **A.** Something that seems like a problem can become a special gift when you share it.
- ◯ **B.** Poems should always be short.
- ◯ **C.** Teachers know everything.
- ◯ **D.** It is best to be exactly like everyone else.

Passage 4 · The Attic Door

Nadia had lived in the old house for three weeks, but she had never noticed the small door at the end of the upstairs hall. It was painted the same dusty blue as the wall, so it seemed to vanish into the shadows. One rainy Saturday, with nothing to do, she ran her fingers along the wall and felt a cool brass handle hidden beneath a curl of peeling paint. Her heart began to race. She pulled, but the door would not budge. She pulled again, leaning back with all her weight, and at last it swung open with a long, slow creak. Behind it rose a narrow staircase, thick with dust and silent as a held breath. Nadia climbed, one careful step at a time, until she reached a small attic room. A single round window let in a soft gray light. Everywhere she looked there were forgotten treasures — a rocking horse with a faded mane, a trunk of yellowed letters, a music box that still played a thin, sweet tune. Nadia sat down among the dusty wonders and smiled. The house had been keeping a secret all along, and now, at last, the secret belonged to her.

199 WORDS · LEXILE 820–940L · RIT 219–225

Q16 RIT 219 · Lexile 820L · Key Detail

Why had Nadia never noticed the small door before?

- ◯ **A.** It was painted the same dusty blue as the wall, so it seemed to vanish into the shadows.
- ◯ **B.** It was locked with a heavy chain.
- ◯ **C.** It was hidden behind a tall bookcase.
- ◯ **D.** It was on a different floor of the house.

Q17 RIT 220 · Lexile 850L · Cause & Effect

What finally happens when Nadia leans back and pulls with all her weight?

- ◯ **A.** The handle breaks off in her hand.
- ◯ **B.** The door swings open with a long, slow creak.
- ◯ **C.** The paint falls from the ceiling.
- ◯ **D.** She decides to go back downstairs.

Q18 RIT 221 Lexile 880L Vocabulary

The passage says the staircase was "silent as a held **breath**." This comparison shows that the staircase was —

- ◯ **A.** very quiet and still.
- ◯ **B.** crowded and noisy.
- ◯ **C.** brightly lit.
- ◯ **D.** warm and sunny.

Q19 RIT 223 Lexile 910L Inference

How does Nadia most likely feel when she reaches the attic room?

- ◯ **A.** Bored and disappointed by the empty space.
- ◯ **B.** Frightened and eager to leave at once.
- ◯ **C.** Angry that the room is so dusty.
- ◯ **D.** Delighted and full of wonder at the forgotten treasures.

Q20 RIT 225 Lexile 940L Theme

What is the theme, or message, of "The Attic Door"?

- ◯ **A.** Old houses are always dangerous.
- ◯ **B.** Rainy days are boring.
- ◯ **C.** Curiosity and patience can lead to the discovery of hidden wonders.
- ◯ **D.** Doors should always be left open.